

IAS MAINS 2020

VALUE ADDITION

GS - I

GS - II

GS - III

GS - IV

12 QUESTIONS WITH MODEL ANSWERS

MODULE - 1

GS – I ... INDIAN SOCIETY

- 1 Climate change and related events affect women more severely in comparison to men. Examine the underlying reasons from Indian context. (150 Words)
- 2 Discuss the deep-rooted cultural ethos, which are proving detrimental to the “physical and mental well-being” of women. (250 Words)
- 3 The ubiquitous nature of digital / social media created huge ideological clash between the young and older generations within the family. Examine its impact on age-old Indian Family System. (250 Words)

GS – II ... CONSTITUTION & POLITY

- 1 “Apart from independence from the Executive, the Judiciary also needs independence from popular narratives”. Elaborate the statement with your viewpoint. (150 Words)
- 2 In recent times, Indian voter is sceptical about “Free & fair Elections”. Do you agree with this statement? Give reasoned arguments. (250 Words)
- 3 Enumerate the similarities and contradictions in the political systems of India and UK. (250 Words)

GS – III ... ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1

How “Artificial Intelligence” and “Big Data” benefit the Indian farmer? What are the constraints in their implementation? (250 Words)

2

Examine how far Joint Liability Groups (JLGs) are successful in providing institutional credit to small and marginal farmers. How do you assess their success vis-à-vis Self Help Groups (SHGs)? (250 Words)

3

Why the initiatives like “System of Rice Intensification”, “Sustainable Sugarcane Initiative”, “Better Cotton Initiative” are called “Sustainable Agricultural Practices”? Critically examine the constraints in scaling up these initiatives, from the Indian context. (250 Words)

GS – IV ...ETHICS & INTEGRITY

- 1 Discuss in detail John Rawls' theory of Distributive Justice. Critically examine whether 10% reservation to economically weaker sections contributes to Distributive Justice. (250 Words)
- 2 Examine the rising Protectionist tendencies across Western nations in light of ethics in International relations. Is 'USA First' Policy justified? (150 Words)
- 3 Why should Private companies contribute funds to Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)? Discuss whether CSR is part of corporate ethics. Is State mandating CSR against promoting free enterprise? (250 Words)

Climate change and related events affect women more severely in comparison to men. Examine the underlying reasons from Indian context. (150 Words)

Climate change and natural disasters affect women differently, and more severely. This is because men and women have different roles, and women by social defaults face discrimination in various forms.

REASONS IN INDIAN CONTEXT

1. Restricted mobility during disasters due to household responsibilities.
2. Less exposure to trainings and information to prepare them to face the eventualities.
3. Gender norms dictate acceptable proper behaviors. For e.g. not learning how to swim, not going out alone.
4. Social stigma of seeing women as weaker sex, deprive using their capabilities during disasters.
5. Women have to walk long distances to fetch water due to changes in climatic conditions.
6. Sexual harassment and loss of privacy in shelters.
7. Suicides of men after natural disasters puts greater social responsibility on women to cater for family needs.



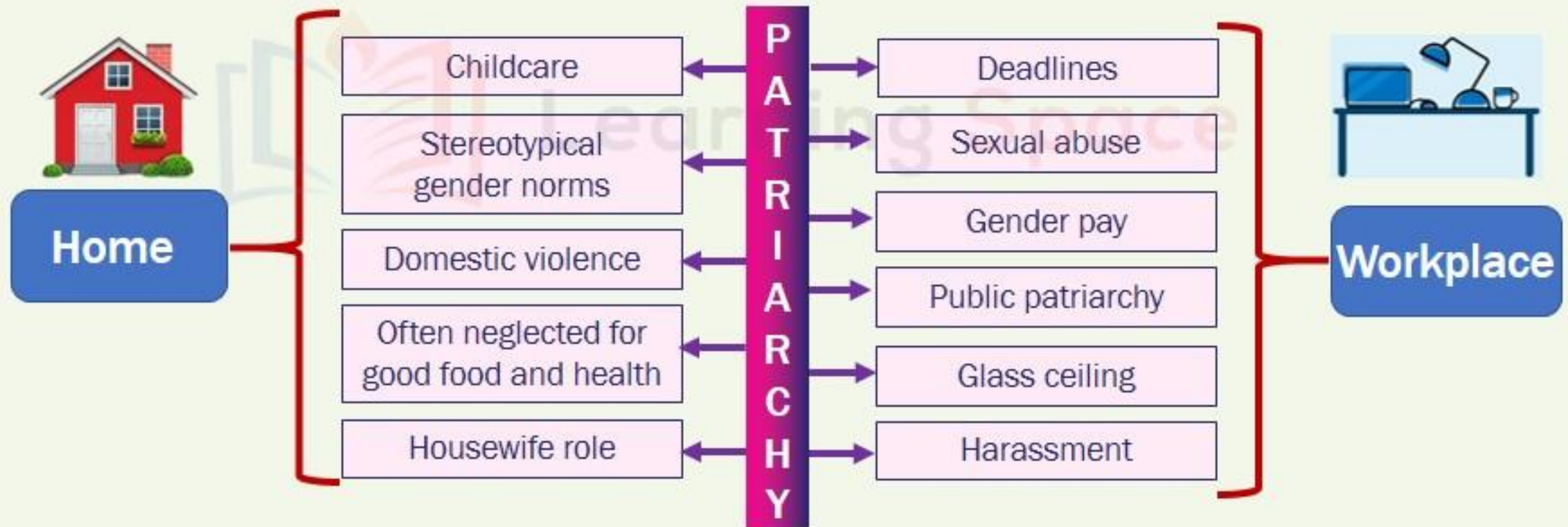
CONCLUSION

For practical and effective climate change mitigation, the latent potential of women must be unleashed. As the Agenda 2030 motto says, "cannot leave anyone behind", gender equality is a prerequisite.



Discuss the deep-rooted cultural ethos, which are proving detrimental to the “physical and mental well-being” of women. (250 Words)

Women remained to be the most exploitative and largest vulnerable section because of the cultural expectations of patriarchy. Besides, the issues at workplace result in physical and mental agony to women.



SUFFERINGS OF WOMEN – A FEW CASES

INCIDENT	PHYSICAL	MENTAL
1	Women working in sugar fields in western Maharashtra undergo Hysterectomy (removal of uterus) under work pressure	Suffer mental trauma post surgery. Also, it is performed in non-institutional health care units.
2	Marital rape and domestic violence at home in villages of Rajasthan	Feeling of being deprived of human emotions. They suffer being objectified.
3	Stripping and beating in public for wearing jeans and using mobile in Rajasthan	Fearing the backlash, they stop fighting for freedom, resulting in psychological disturbances.
4	Sexual harassment at workplace	Fear working outside, deprive themselves of financial independence and freedom.

EFFORTS OF GOVERNMENT

- Enacting and implementation of Sexual harassment of women at workplace act, 2013.
- SHE-teams to prevent abuse of women in Public.
- Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005
- Self Help Groups as a means for grass root empowerment of women.
- Enabled gender budgeting and women specific allocation of funds in every government department.

NEED FOR MORE ATTENTION

- No law or policy to protect women from weaker sections.
Eg: Working women in Maharashtra sugarcane fields.
- Marital rape is not criminalized.
- Awareness campaigns on sexual harassment, women empowerment are not popular.

WAY AHEAD

Government should establish safeguards for women, especially from weaker sections and backward communities. Promoting information campaigns and collaborating with NGOs is needed to bring social awareness about women issues and their rights.

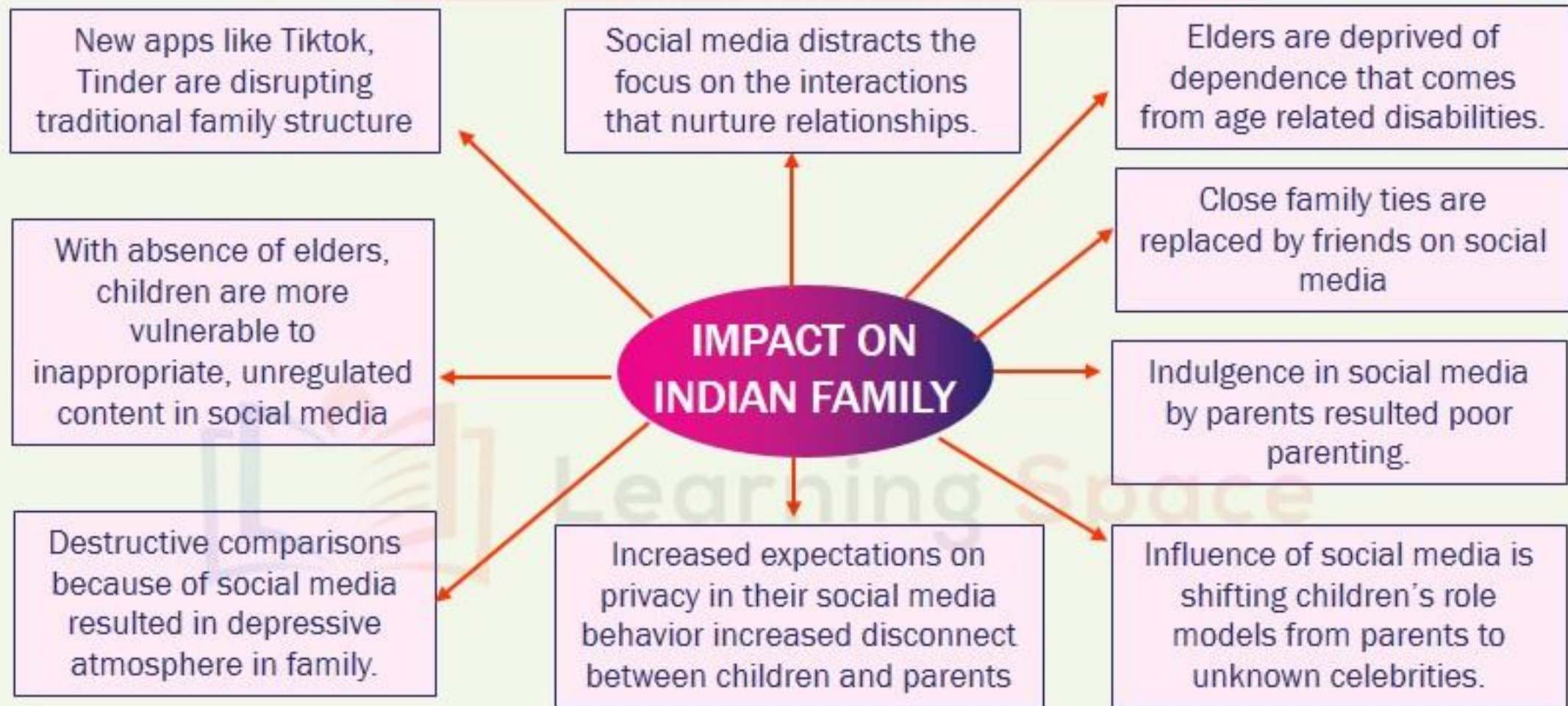
The ubiquitous nature of digital / social media created huge ideological clash between the young and older generations within the family. Examine its impact on age-old Indian Family System. (250 Words)

The advent of digital media changed people's everyday lives and the way they connect across generations. While the Millennials and Generation Z spend their time in virtual space, the older generations are deprived of family emotions and interpersonal relations.

IDEOLOGICAL CLASHES

- Millennials and Generation Z are more open to put forward their personal choices than blindly following the elders suggestions.
- Sceptical about irrational superstitions and rituals.
- Old generations seek more family time while millennials want more private time.
- Interactions on social media led to own decisions regarding career and marriage choices.
- Have fresh perspectives about social situations, whereas the old people stuck with their traditional perspectives.
- New generation women see social media as a means to freedom but elders see it as a threat to patriarchal structure.





WAY AHEAD

- Government should conduct awareness campaigns for parents and children on usage and effects of social media.
- Social media should be used as an empowerment tool than to indulge in pleasurable activities.
- Family should spend time to know the needs and requirements of one another.

“Apart from independence from the Executive, the Judiciary also needs independence from popular narratives”. Elaborate the statement with your viewpoint. (150 Words)

Article 50 provides for separate executive from the judiciary. But, recent incidents of popular agitations influencing judicial judgements call for Judiciary to work independent of public sentiments.

ILL-EFFECTS OF POPULAR NARRATIVES INFLUENCING JUDICIARY

- Judicial overreach under popular pressure.
- Loss of public trust in judiciary and justice.
- Delay in Judgements fearing majority opinions.
- Justice yielding to majoritarianism is a danger to democracy.
- Courts may compromise justice by delivering judgements deviating from law.
- Establishes wrong conventions in delivering justice.

RECENT INCIDENTS OF POPULAR NARRATIVE

- Delay in Ayodhya judgement.
- Death sentence to the convicts of Nirbhaya case.
- Delay in pardoning the convicts of Rajeev Gandhi assassination case.

CONCLUSION

When the legislative and executive wings get swept away from their duties and goals under the Constitution by waves of populism, the Judiciary has to rise and stand up to the populist forces and protect the Constitutional ethos from being desecrated by the populists.



In recent times, Indian voter is sceptical about “Free & Fair Elections”. Do you agree with this statement? Give reasoned arguments. (250 Words)

Free and fair elections form the bed rock in establishing representative democracy. However, the Indian voter in recent times has been increasingly sceptical about free and fair elections, and this in turn wanes people's trust in the election process.





EFFORTS OF ECI

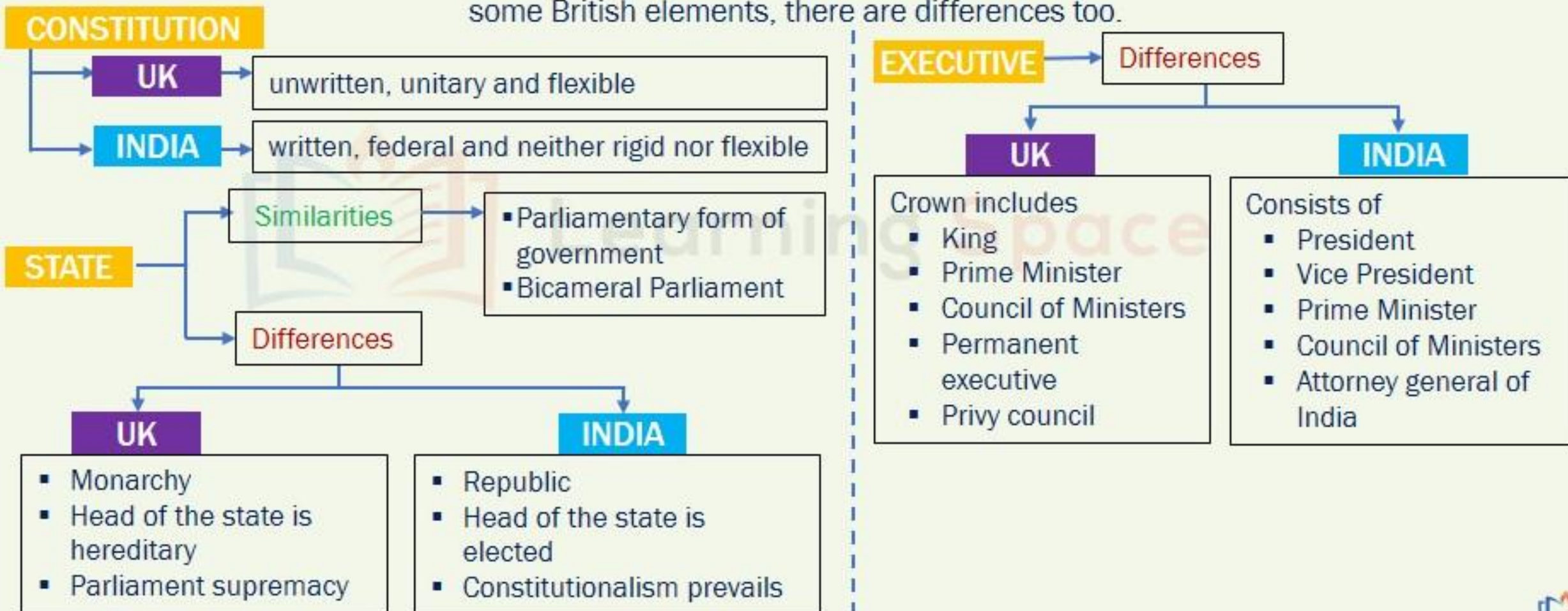
- C-Vigil
- Challenge to hack EVMs
- Usage of stand alone tamper proof EVMs
- Strict implementation of MCC
- Appointment of special officers to monitor election functioning

WAY AHEAD

- A Parliamentary committee to increase the powers of EC in the new digital age has to be set up.
- Effective reforms with regard to funding, strict compliance of MCC, ethical reporting by media, legal weakness in the existing law relating to entry of criminals in politics are the need of the hour.

Enumerate the similarities and contradictions in the political systems of India and UK. (250 Words)

British political system is a specimen of evolutionary development. Though, Indian political system inherited some British elements, there are differences too.



IAS MAINS 2020 - VALUE ADDITION

EXECUTIVE

Differences

UK

- Shadow cabinet

INDIA

- No Shadow cabinet

Similarities

- PM is the head of the government and real head of the State.
- Other ministers are appointed on the advice of PM.
- Life of house and term of other ministers depend on PM.
- All ministers swim or sink together.

PRIME MINISTER

Differences

UK

- Convention that PM will always be from Lower house.

INDIA

- PM can be a member of either house of Parliament.

LEGISLATURE

DIFFERENCES

UK

House of Lords/Upper House

- Has hereditary members
- Relatively weaker and acts as delaying chamber

INDIA

- No hereditary members.
- Has equal powers with lower house in aspects of ordinary and constitutional amendment bills.

House of commons/Lower House

- Strongest with most authority.

- Relatively weaker because of constitutionalism.

Speaker

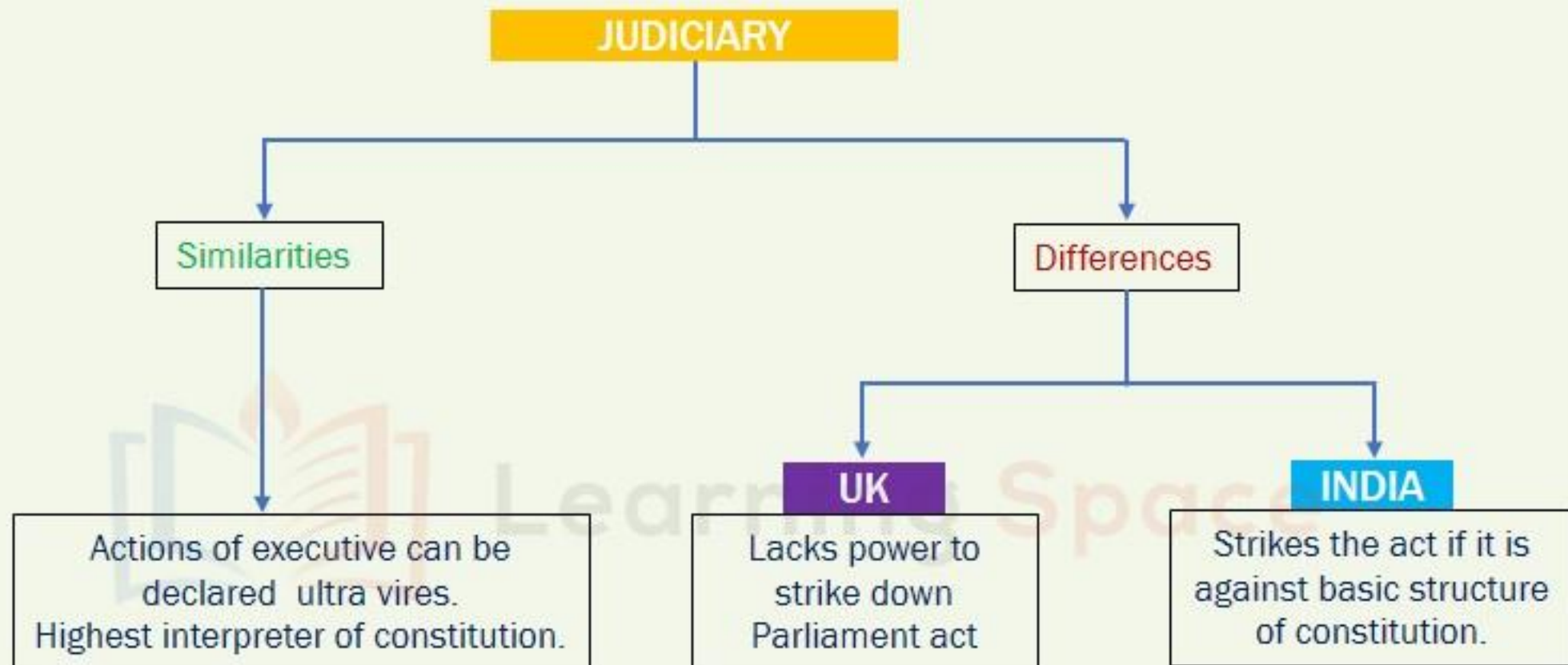
- Non-political
- Gives formal resignation from political parties.
- Speaker's constituency is unchallenged

- Not necessary for speaker to resign from party
- No disqualification under anti-defection, if he resigns
- No convention that he will be elected uncontested

SIMILARITIES

Speaker

- Speaker has a casting vote
- Ultimate disciplinary powers w.r.t conduct of house



CONCLUSION

Though Indian political system shares some similarities with that of the UK, it is uniquely tailor made to suit the needs of society and diversity of the nation.

How “Artificial Intelligence” and “Big Data” benefit the Indian farmer? What are the constraints in their implementation? (250 Words)

India has ~30 million farmers who own smartphones. It is expected to grow 3 times by 2020 and 315 million rural Indians will be using internet by 2020. Big data and sector-specific machine learning tools will help in increasing agricultural productivity, inputs and produce management, and farmers income.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- Remote sensors, Satellites, and UAVs gather information to monitor plant health, soil condition, temperature, humidity etc.
- Cognitive technologies facilitate farmers in making decisions to maximize crop and livestock output.
- AI powered chat-bots give advice and recommendations on specific farm problems.

BIG DATA FROM AGRICULTURE

- Helps in extensive analysis of National projects such as AGMARKNET, e-NAM, Animal Health, Soil Health etc., at micro-level granularity at various levels to make comprehensive meaning of the data.
- Helps in accurate prediction of rainfall and extreme weather events, enabling greater participation of farmers.
- Enables weather-index based insurance, financial and credit programs to manage financial, weather and climate risks.



CONSTRAINTS IN IMPLEMENTATION

- Dependence on traditional agricultural practices.
- Lack of inter-operability: Currently, ICT components of multiple vendors do not operate as one integrated farm information system.
- Lack of universal access to digital technologies
- Lack of farming community capacity building for using such technologies
- Scarcity of information content in local languages

CONCLUSION

Design and development of AI algorithms to process vast agricultural seasonal data can be challenging yet necessary in an agricultural setting. Appropriate and timely adoption of such technologies need capacity building of farmers. It leads to smart, sustainable farming and comprehensive integrated farming.

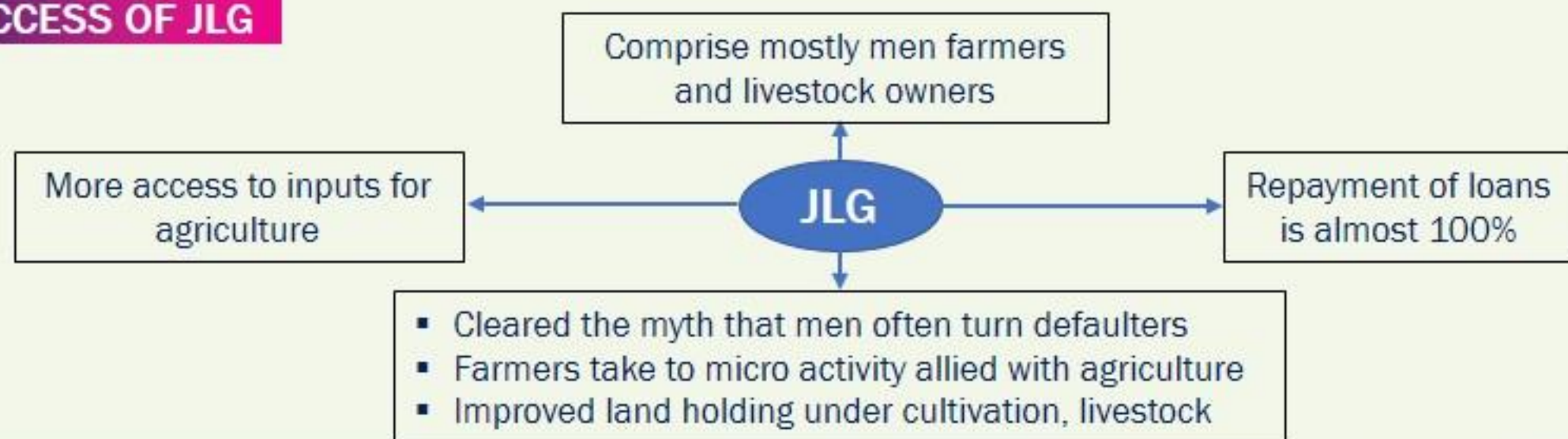
Examine how far Joint Liability Groups (JLGs) are successful in providing institutional credit to small and marginal farmers. How do you assess their success vis-à-vis Self Help Groups (SHGs)? (150 Words)

Both SHG and JLG are channels for financial inclusion of poor. In these groups, peer pressure acts as social collateral to offset the lack of hard collateral by small and marginal farmers.

JOINT LIABILITY GROUP

Informal group of 4-10 members from weaker sections to avail institutional loan based on mutual guarantee and shared liability

SUCCESS OF JLG



SUCCESS OF JLG VS SHG

S. NO	SUBJECT	JLG	SHG
1	Group	- Smaller with 4-10 members - Easy for banks to persuade the members to take to micro activity	- Consists of 15-20 members - It is more of a group's interest than bank's to diversify opportunities
2	Members	Include men mostly from farming and livestock	Mostly composed of women
3	Access to credit	Avails individual as well as group loan	Largely group loan
4	Success of repayment	- More peer pressure because of shared liability - Smaller group facilitates faster repayment	- No shared liability - Larger group needs dealing with more members
5	Exploitation	No major events of exploitation by MFIs	- Incidents of exploitation of SHG members by MFIs - Eg: Andhra Pradesh
6	Outcomes	- Better access to agri inputs - Improved livestock	Empowered women to start economic activities
7	Regions	Mostly successful in North Indian States like UP, MP etc.	Successful in Southern States like Tamil Nadu

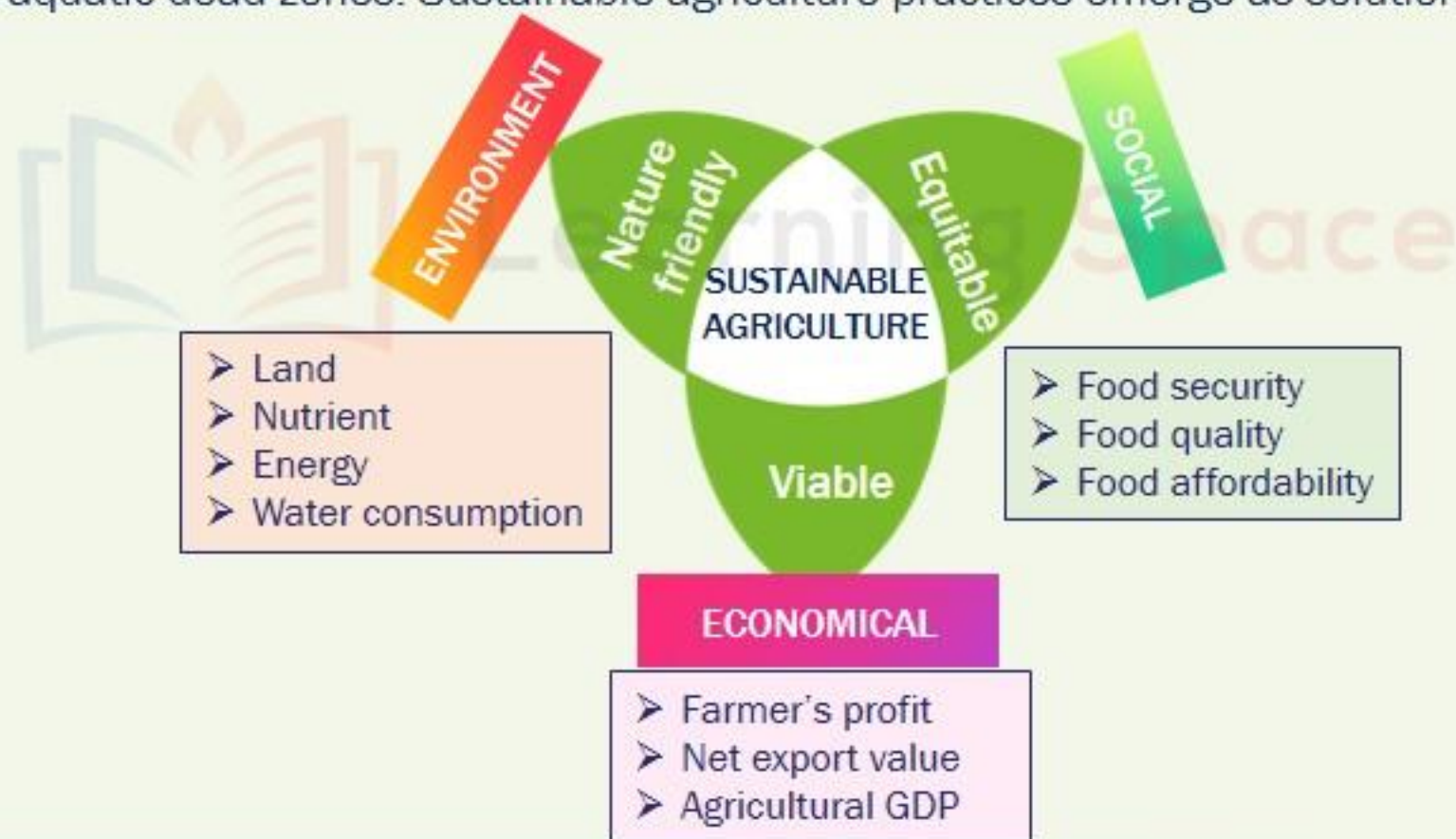
WAY AHEAD

Success of JLGs have to be extended to remote part of India with prompt monitoring. SHGs can be further split into JLGs to increase the benefits of financial inclusion.



Why the initiatives like “System of Rice Intensification”, “Sustainable Sugarcane Initiative”, “Better Cotton Initiative” are called “Sustainable Agricultural Practices”? Critically examine the constraints in scaling up these initiatives, from the Indian context. (250 Words)

Globally, agriculture is succeeding in production but failing miserably in sustainability. Farming practices like frequent tillage and monoculture degrade soil health; overuse of herbicides made super-weeds epidemic; and fertilizer runoff produces aquatic dead zones. Sustainable agriculture practices emerge as solutions to these practices

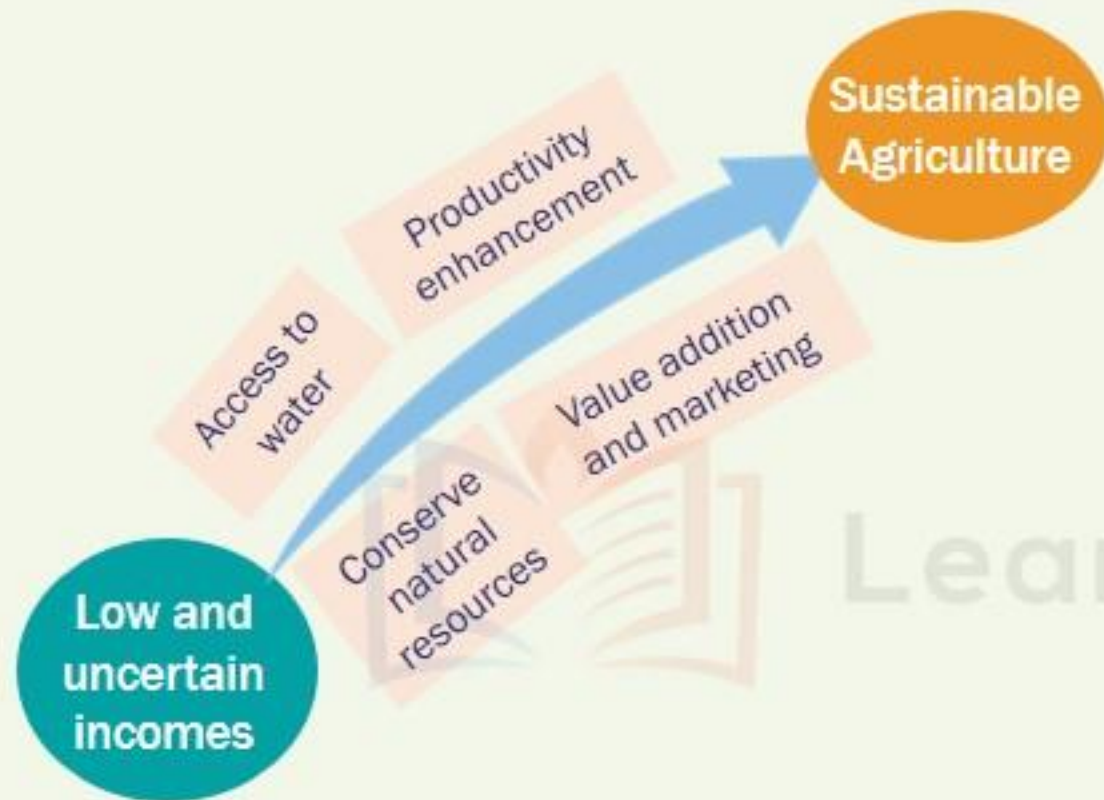


SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURAL PRACTICES

- It means management of resources for agriculture balancing human needs, environment quality, and conserving natural resources.
- Aims at providing food for the present generation while keeping future generation needs in mind.
- Includes activities such as vermicomposting, crop rotation, cover crop farming, eliminating or reducing tillage etc., Initiatives such as System of Rice Intensification (SRI), Sustainable Sugarcane Initiative (SSI), Better Cotton Initiative (BCI) practice these Sustainable Agricultural activities.

BENEFITS

- Improved water use efficiency
- Raises productivity of land
- Optimum use of fertilizers favour balanced availability of nutrients
- Better aeration and more penetration of sunlight
- Reduced cost of cultivation and increased returns through intercropping
- Reduces ecological foot-print.



WAY AHEAD

'More-from-less' sustainable agriculture approaches such as SSI, SRI and BCI deliver higher production at lower economic and ecological costs. Government should encourage initiatives like joint local groups. Along with financial, credit the group of farmers are to be persuaded to adopt these sustainable practices.

CONSTRAINTS IN SCALING UP THESE INITIATIVES IN INDIA

- Around 86% small and marginal farmers with little or no training in using pesticides.
- Failure of state to use agri-extension services, scientific community to bring these sustainable practices to fields.
- Practice of agriculture based on state policies like MSP than agro-climatic conditions.
- Absence of corporate farming disabled bringing these practices to fields.
- No specific training through local subject experts for these agriculture practices.
- Poor market access infrastructure.
- Difficult to convince the farmers to embrace these practices.

Discuss in detail John Rawls' theory of Distributive Justice. Critically examine whether 10% reservation to economically weaker sections contributes to Distributive Justice.
(250 Words)

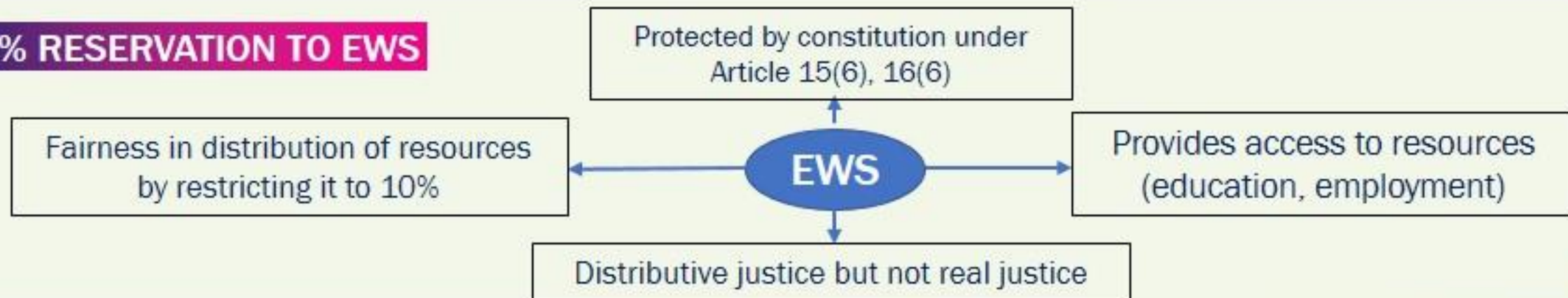
According to John Rawls, ignorance of details about oneself (class, caste, social status, strength and psychological abilities) will lead to principles that are fair to all.

If an individual doesn't know how he will end up in his own conceived society, she/he chooses such society where justice treats all fairly (Distributive Justice).

DISTRIBUTIVE JUSTICE - EQUITY

- Unequal societies need equity as principle of distribution of resources (education, health, employment etc.)
- Government policies to be biased in favor of poorer and weaker sections.
- If resources are limited, they must be utilized for weaker sections.
- Reservations in Indian Constitution follows this principle.

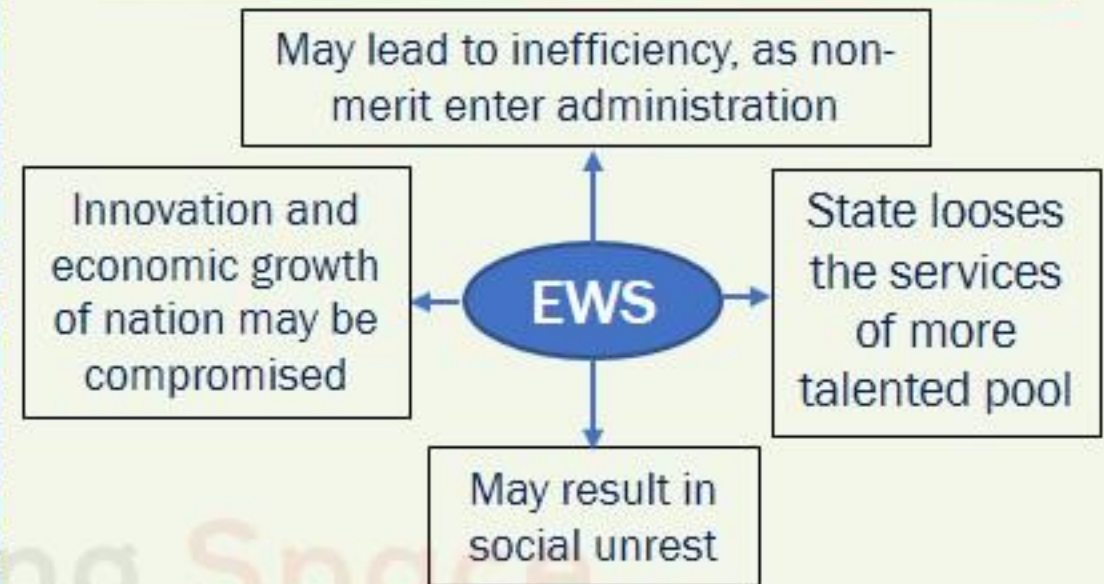
10% RESERVATION TO EWS



DISTRIBUTIVE JUSTICE Vs REAL JUSTICE



EWS: NOT BEING REAL JUSTICE



WAY AHEAD

Government should invest on empowering weaker sections through -

- Nutritious food
- Quality health services
- Quality education
- Skills to hone their capabilities

This results in transforming distributive justice to real justice.



Examine the rising Protectionist tendencies across Western nations in light of ethics in International relations. Is 'USA First' Policy justified? (150 Words)

The rise of protectionism is against the traditional Indian philosophy of Vasudaika Kutumbakam (entire people on the earth are one family).

PROTECTIONIST TENDENCIES

Perceived failure of globalization by USA and other EU nations

Restrictions like

- Increasing tariffs
- Removing immigrant permits
- Hatred towards refugees

MOTIVES BEHIND PROTECTIONISM:

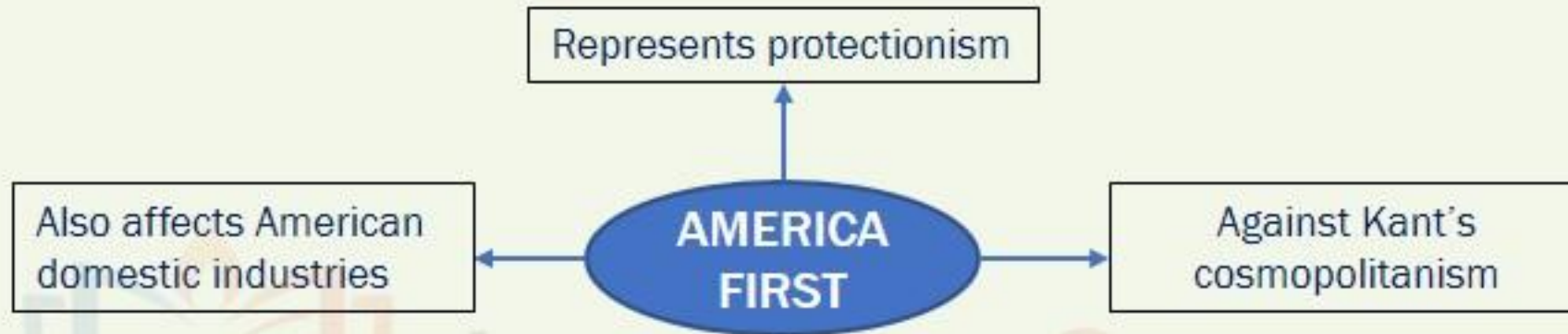
- To boost one's own economy
- Shield economy from foreign competition
- Guided by self interest of making their nation great
- Fear of resource grab by immigrants

INTERNATIONAL ETHICS

- Follows enlightened self interest:
 - ✓ The well being of a nation depends on the well being of the entire world.
- It champions Kant's cosmopolitanism – Every person on earth has the right to utilize all its resources.

Protectionist measures might be good in short term from the perspective of individual nations, but they can have long term adverse consequences from the global perspective.

USA FIRST POLICY



Hence, the USA first policy is not justified from the view of international ethics.

3/ EIA
GS - IV

Why should Private companies contribute funds to Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)? Discuss whether CSR is part of corporate ethics. Is State mandating CSR against promoting free enterprise? (250 Words)

Corporate social responsibility (CSR) is an integral part of corporate ethics. CSR comes under the scope of ethical, legal and economic aspects of corporate governance.





STATE MANDATING CSR



- State can't take entire social responsibility as its finances are limited.
- State's responsibility is to ensure institutions work under rules and regulations.
- It is not against free enterprise but promotes ethical enterprise.
- State facilitates corporates to pay back its gratitude to society.

CONCLUSION

As Gandhi said, Commerce without morality is a sin. CSR enables Commerce with the morality in the real sense. It promotes well being of the society apart from earning profits for the corporates themselves.

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SINCERE THANKS
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